



# VAERION

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## Brand Book

PHASE Ω · v0.1.7-rc2 · Founder: Auren

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The Vaerion design system — one visual language across the seal, the terminal, the reports, and the web. Luxury here means refinement, not decoration: every rule below exists to make the product feel calm, confident, precise, and elegant.

**Generated assets:** everything under `brand/logo/`, `brand/png/`, and `public/` (icons, og image) is produced by `tools/brand-render.ts`. Never hand-edit an artifact — change the geometry source and regenerate. Running the generator twice produces identical bytes (verified).

**Mirrors:** terminal tokens are mirrored in `packages/vaerion/src/cli/ui.ts`; the web face uses the same hex values.

## 1 The mark

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The **Seal** — a rounded square containing the **Witness Rule** above the **V**. The rule is the line of evidence; the V is verification descending to a single point. Two elements, one statement: measured, then verified.

VAERION

The wordmark — ink edition. Custom monoline caps drawn in the brand renderer, not a font (`vaerion-wordmark.svg`).



The seal in the three physical editions — gold on ink (the signature edition), white on ink, black on light surfaces (print, documents).

| Asset                | File                                                       | Use                                      |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Seal (icon)          | brand/logo/vaerion-icon.svg                                | app icon, favicon source, avatars        |
| Monogram (bare mark) | brand/logo/vaerion-monogram.svg                            | inline marks, watermarks, loading states |
| Wordmark             | brand/logo/vaerion-wordmark.svg (ink) / -light (porcelain) | headers, documents                       |
| Primary lockup       | brand/logo/vaerion-logo.svg (gold-on-ink) / -light         | hero surfaces, release pages, OG         |
| Favicon              | public/favicon.svg + public/favicon-32.png                 | browser tab                              |

Table 1.1 — The mark: assets and where they belong.

| Edition      | File               | Rule                                                     |
|--------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Gold</b>  | editions/gold.svg  | the signature edition — dark surfaces, release moments   |
| <b>White</b> | editions/white.svg | dark surfaces where gold would compete with data         |
| <b>Black</b> | editions/black.svg | light surfaces (print, documents)                        |
| <b>Mono</b>  | editions/mono.svg  | single-color contexts; follows <code>currentColor</code> |

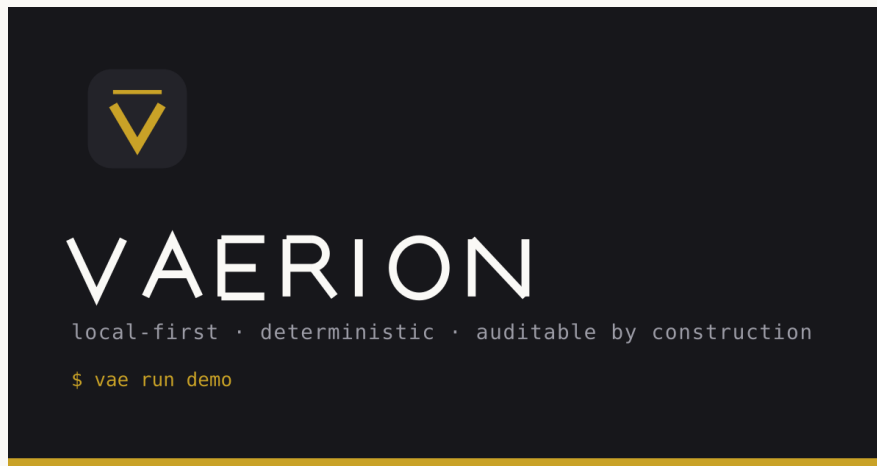
Table 1.2 — Editions. All files under `brand/logo/editions/`.

## Clearspace & size

- Clearspace: keep  $1 \times$  rule-width ( $\approx 1/28$  of the seal height) free on all sides;  $2 \times$  preferred in print.
- The seal reads from **16 px**; use the monogram (no container) below 24 px.
- Never: rotate, recolor outside the palette, add effects/shadows to the mark, place the wordmark inside the seal, or stretch any axis.



The primary lockup, gold-on-ink — hero surfaces, release pages, OG.



Open Graph card (og-image.png) — the lockup as it ships to link previews.

## 2 Color

The palette is ink, porcelain, and **one** accent: gold. Everything else is neutral. Semantic colors exist only for evidence states (success / warning / error / info) and are muted, never neon.

|  | Token   | Hex                                                  | Role |
|--|---------|------------------------------------------------------|------|
|  | #17171B | primary surface, black-edition foreground            |      |
|  | #232329 | raised surface on ink                                |      |
|  | #FAF9F6 | light surface                                        |      |
|  | #C9A227 | <b>the</b> accent — headers of state, key highlights |      |
|  | #E3B341 | gold on dark surfaces and small sizes                |      |
|  | #55555E | secondary text                                       |      |
|  | #9C9CA6 | muted text, captions                                 |      |
|  | #2A2A31 | hairlines on ink                                     |      |

Table 2.1 — Core palette. Swatches show each token at its hex value.

|  | Token   | Hex                        | Meaning |
|--|---------|----------------------------|---------|
|  | #3F9B6E | verified,<br>green path    |         |
|  | #C98A1F | attention,<br>repair hints |         |
|  | #C24E4E | refusal,<br>failure        |         |
|  | #6B8FA3 | neutral<br>guidance        |         |
|  | #8A8A93 | de-emphasis                |         |

Table 2.2 — Terminal evidence colors (used by the CLI).

**Rules:** gold is never used for body text; red appears **only** for failures; color always accompanies a word or symbol (never color alone — accessibility law); NO\_COLOR / non-TTY strips every color (the CLI’s plain mode is the fallback for everyone).

### 3 Typography

| Use                      | Face                                        | Notes                                        |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Display / UI             | Inter (web: Geist Sans)                     | tight tracking on large sizes, sentence case |
| Terminal / code / hashes | Geist Mono, JetBrains Mono, or ui-monospace | the engine’s native voice                    |
| Print / PDF              | Inter + JetBrains Mono                      | same hierarchy rules                         |

Table 3.1 — Typefaces by surface. This edition is set in DejaVu Sans and DejaVu Sans Mono: the documented faces are unavailable in this environment.

Hierarchy: page/panel titles 20–28 semibold · section labels 13–14 uppercase +10% tracking · body 15–16/1.6 · captions & evidence metadata 12–13 in *mist/dim*. Hashes, ids, and code always mono. Never fake small-caps, never more than two families per surface.

The **wordmark** letterforms are custom monoline caps drawn in the brand renderer — not a font. Never re-typeset “VAERION” as a substitute for the wordmark asset.

## 4 Geometry

| Token         | Value                                                                                          | Notes                               |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Grid          | 4 px base; 8 px rhythm                                                                         | all padding/spacing multiples of 4  |
| Spacing scale | 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64                                                            |                                     |
| Radius        | seal 104/512 $\approx$ 20% · cards 12 · inputs 8 · badges 999                                  | one radius family per surface class |
| Hairlines     | 1 px, line on ink / #E5E3DE on porcelain                                                       | borders whisper, never shout        |
| Shadows       | ink surfaces: none · light surfaces: 0 1 2<br>rgba(23,23,27,.06), 0 8 24<br>rgba(23,23,27,.08) | elevation is rare                   |

Table 4.1 — Geometry tokens.

## 5 Motion

Calm by law: **150-250 ms**, ease-out, opacity + transform only.

- Enter: 180 ms ease-out, 4 px rise + fade.
- Exit: 140 ms ease-in, fade.
- Progress: indeterminate shimmer  $\leq$  2% luminance amplitude; determinate bars never animate backwards.
- No bounce, no parallax, no attention-seeking loops. Reduced-motion (`prefers-reduced-motion`) collapses everything to instant.

## 6 Icon language

Lucide (stroke 1.5-2, round caps) in the web app; a fixed set of Unicode glyphs in the terminal (see `packages/vaerion/src/cli/ui.ts` — the glyphs are chosen to degrade gracefully in non-Unicode terminals). Icons label state, they never decorate: ✓ success · ✗ failure · ⚠ warning · → guidance. One icon per row; never icons + badges + color for the same signal.

## 7 Terminal

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The CLI is the product's front door. Law:

- 1 **Plain mode is a contract** — non-TTY output is stable text; machines and tests depend on it. Rich rendering activates only on a TTY (`VAE_UI=plain|rich|auto` overrides).
- 2 **One layout system** — every screen is composed from the same components (panel, table, badge, steps, receipt). No free-hand output.
- 3 **Unicode box drawing** with ASCII-safe degradation.
- 4 **Evidence over ornament** — color and glyphs mark verification state; nothing blinks, nothing spins unless work is actually running.

## 8 Voice

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Engineered, declarative, exact. Sentences short. Numbers measured. No exclamation marks, no hype, no “blazing fast”. A receipt reads like a notary document; an error reads like a colleague: what failed, why, the fix, the doc.

## A Appendix — asset inventory & reproduction

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Every generated artifact, its source of record, and its intended use. All paths are relative to the repository root.



| Asset                        | File                                                                                                                                    | Intended use                                                    |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Seal (icon)                  | brand/logo/vaerion-icon.svg                                                                                                             | app icon, favicon source, avatars                               |
| Monogram (bare mark)         | brand/logo/vaerion-monogram.svg                                                                                                         | inline marks, watermarks, loading states                        |
| Wordmark (ink)               | brand/logo/vaerion-wordmark.svg                                                                                                         | headers, documents — light surfaces                             |
| Wordmark (porcelain)         | brand/logo/vaerion-wordmark-light.svg                                                                                                   | headers, documents — dark surfaces                              |
| Primary lockup (gold-on-ink) | brand/logo/vaerion-logo.svg                                                                                                             | hero surfaces, release pages, OG                                |
| Primary lockup (light)       | brand/logo/vaerion-logo-light.svg                                                                                                       | hero surfaces on porcelain                                      |
| Edition — Gold               | brand/logo/editions/gold.svg                                                                                                            | the signature edition — dark surfaces, release moments          |
| Edition — White              | brand/logo/editions/white.svg                                                                                                           | dark surfaces where gold would compete with data                |
| Edition — Black              | brand/logo/editions/black.svg                                                                                                           | light surfaces (print, documents)                               |
| Edition — Mono               | brand/logo/editions/mono.svg                                                                                                            | single-color contexts; follows <code>currentColor</code>        |
| Favicon (vector)             | public/favicon.svg                                                                                                                      | browser tab                                                     |
| Favicon (raster)             | public/favicon-32.png                                                                                                                   | browser tab                                                     |
| Rendered PNG editions        | brand/png/ — seal-gold-1024.png · logo-gold-2400.png · wordmark-ink-2000.png · seal-white-1024.png · seal-black-1024.png · og-image.png | pixel-surface renders of the SVG sources — icons, hero, OG card |

Table A.1 — Asset inventory. SVG files are the geometry source of record; PNG editions are renders of those sources.

## Reproduction

```
bun run tools/brand-render.ts
```

Running the generator twice produces identical bytes (verified). Never hand-edit an artifact — change the geometry source and regenerate; every asset under `brand/logo/`, `brand/png/`, and `public/` is reproducible from the source alone. This book is a print edition of that system: `brand/BRAND-BOOK.md` remains the content of record.